

Class Notes: Class Reptilia

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

Terrestrial Adaptations

Characterised by creeping/crawling locomotion; mostly terrestrial; body covered by dry cornified skin with epidermal scales/scutes. No external ears but tympanum present; two pairs of limbs when present; heart three-chambered (four-chambered in crocodiles); poikilothermous.

Reproduction and Examples

Snakes and lizards shed their scales as skin cast. Sexes separate; internal fertilisation; oviparous; direct development. Examples: Chelone (turtle), Testudo (tortoise), Chameleon, Calotes (garden lizard), Crocodilus, Alligator, Hemidactylus (wall lizard); poisonous snakes — Naja (cobra), Bangarus (krait), Vipera (viper).